PROJECT DESIGN PHASE

Problem Solution Fit Canvas

For standard laptop order automation with Flow Designer

Session detail	Working value
Date	1 October 2026
Team / facilitator	SWTID-2026-2670
Project	Streamlining IT procurement
Status	Discovery canvas; assumptions unvalidated

Purpose

Use this canvas to test whether a clearly defined person has a meaningful problem, and whether the proposed solution addresses it in a way they will use. “Automate standard laptop orders with Flow Designer” is the project’s solution direction, not evidence of customer need or solution fit. Complete the problem side first, then record evidence and decide what to test.

Map one customer segment at a time

Possible participants include employees requesting a laptop, managers supporting or approving a request, IT service or endpoint teams, and procurement coordinators. Select the role supported by your research; do not combine different roles in one map.

Problem fit canvas

Capture direct quotes and observed behavior. Mark interpretation as a hypothesis and note the source. The prompts below are cues, not project findings.

1 CUSTOMER SEGMENT(S)

Who is the person and what context matters?

Which request type or journey stage?

Notes / evidence

2 JOBS TO BE DONE / PROBLEMS

What outcome are they trying to achieve?

What problem or friction prevents it?

Notes / evidence

3 TRIGGERS

What event makes them act now?

What creates urgency or starts the request?

Notes / evidence

4 PROBLEM ROOT CAUSE

What process, information, or system condition causes the problem?

What evidence separates cause from symptom?

Notes / evidence

5 CUSTOMER CONSTRAINTS

What policy, time, budget, access, location, or device constraints apply?

Which constraints are confirmed?

Notes / evidence

6 EMOTIONS BEFORE / AFTER

How does the person describe the experience before and after?

Capture reported words; do not infer emotion.

Notes / evidence

Behavior and solution fit

Complete the remaining canvas sections using the same customer segment and situation from page 1. Compare the proposed solution with what people already do.

7 AVAILABLE SOLUTIONS / ALTERNATIVES	8 BEHAVIOR
How is the request handled today? What tools, manual workarounds, or support channels are used? **Notes / evidence**	What does the person actually do to get the job done? Where do they wait, repeat work, follow up, or change channels? **Notes / evidence**
9 CHANNELS OF BEHAVIOR	**10 YOUR SOLUTION**
Online: portal, catalog, email, ticket, chat, other? Offline: conversation, phone, paper, handoff, other? **Notes / evidence**	What is the smallest Flow Designer-supported change being considered? What user problem should it address, and what remains manual? **Notes / evidence**

Fit hypothesis

Hypothesis element	Draft to complete
Problem / behavior fit	We believe [customer segment] needs to [job] but experiences [validated problem] when [trigger/context], because [evidence-backed cause]. Today they [observed behavior / alternative].
Solution fit	We believe [small solution concept using Flow Designer or another option] will help [customer segment] achieve [outcome] by [mechanism], while respecting [constraints / controls].
Value and adoption	People will choose or use this because [observed motivation / advantage over current alternative]. Adoption signal: [observable behavior].
Riskiest assumption	[What must be true for the solution to work and be adopted? What evidence could disprove it?]

Success signals to consider

Choose measures with a baseline, definition, data source, and owner before setting targets. Candidate signals include complete requests at first submission, elapsed time by stage, manual touches or rework, status inquiries, exception rate, policy-compliant routing, and requester or coordinator feedback. No baseline or target is assumed here.

Test, learn, and decide

Use a small, low-risk test before committing to a full workflow build. Test the problem and solution assumptions separately where possible.

Experiment field	Plan
Problem hypothesis to test	[Which user, job, trigger, barrier, and cause?]
Solution hypothesis to test	[What small intervention or Flow Designer prototype will be tested?]
Riskiest assumption	[What could make the problem unimportant or the proposed solution unusable?]
Method and participants	[Interview, request review, process observation, prototype walkthrough; roles to include]
Evidence and data source	[Quotes, observed task steps, request/ticket records, timing, approval or handoff evidence]
Success signal and threshold	[Metric, baseline, target/decision threshold; define before running the test]
Constraints and safeguards	[Policy approvals, privacy, data access, manual fallback, exception handling]
Owner and timing	[Experiment owner, stakeholders, date / duration]

Results and decision log

Observation / evidence	What it means for fit	Decision / next step	Owner / date
[Record actual evidence and source]	[Supports / weakens / unclear]	[Continue / revise / test again / stop]	[TBD]
[Record actual evidence and source]	[Supports / weakens / unclear]	[Continue / revise / test again / stop]	[TBD]
[Record actual evidence and source]	[Supports / weakens / unclear]	[Continue / revise / test again / stop]	[TBD]

Fit review

Problem fit	Solution fit	Open gap / decision
[Is the problem frequent, costly, urgent, or otherwise important to the selected segment? Cite evidence.]	[Does the proposed intervention improve the outcome compared with the current alternative? Cite evidence.]	[What is still unknown? Who decides the next step?]

Decision rule: continue only when the evidence supports the defined problem and the proposed solution improves the user outcome without violating required controls. Otherwise revise the segment, problem, solution, or test and record why.